Platycrater arguta

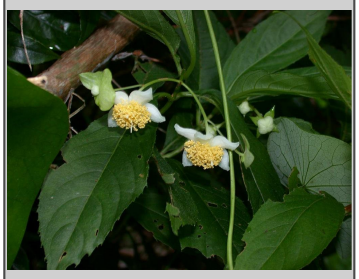
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Also known as: Hydrangea platyarguta (synonym) | Family: Hydrangeaceae (formerly Saxifragaceae)

Passage N_S: 69 **TOTAL 69**



HABIT



OTHER



OTHER



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Semi-evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 0.5–3 m (1.5–10 ft) high. Graceful, rounded, arching Can be more prostrate or rooting at nodes in some forms

Sun

Water

Soil
Prefers humid conditions; stream banks, valleys, mountain slopes in native range

Zone 8a
Hardy in USDA Zones 7–9 (or broader based on elevation range). Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a. Deciduous or semi-evergreen in mild winters. Leaves emerge early (late March); yellow fall color in Zone 8

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to China (Anhui, Fujian, Jiangxi, Zhejiang) and Japan. Sparse forests, thickets, valleys, stream banks, mountain slopes at 400–1800 m

Form
Deciduous (semi-evergreen in mild winters) shrub with opposite, lanceolate to elliptic leaves (9–15 × 3–6 cm), serrate margins, bright green emerging, yellowing in fall. Distinctive sterile flowers: 3–4 white, broadly ovate sepals fused into triangle or square (translucent, net-veined, 2.5–2.8 cm). Fertile flowers smaller with yellow stamens. Capsules with long styles. Branchlets brown. Unique “flat bowl” sterile flowers (Platy = flat, crater = bowl). Sometimes listed under Hydrangea. Chinese plants described as var. sinensis in some treatments. Attractive foliage and floral structure

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Best in filtered light with consistent moisture and good drainage. Avoid drying out. Suitable for shade gardens or woodland edges. Propagate by seed or cuttings.
Leaves used for tea in some traditional contexts

HEALTH

Health

No serious problems stated. Attracts insects to flowers. Generally low maintenance in suitable conditions

Symptoms

None stated